ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE B

Vote YES on Measure B, a fair, fiscally responsible way to support Gilroy's essential services without raising taxes on Gilroy residents.

Measure B updates Gilroy's hotel tax (Transient Occupancy Tax), paid only by hotel, motel, and short-term rental guests staying thirty days or less. Gilroy residents do not pay this tax — visitors do. Yet visitors use our streets, parks, and police and fire services every day they are here. Measure B simply asks our guests to contribute their fair share toward the community they enjoy.

Gilroy's hotel tax rate has not changed since 1983 and remains among the lowest in Santa Clara County. Visitors already pay similar rates in neighboring cities. Every year we wait, Gilroy leaves revenue behind while residents shoulder the full cost of city services.

Measure B raises the rate from 9% to 11%, with a voter-approved maximum of 13%. The City Council may adjust the rate only by resolution at a public meeting, and never above the ceiling you approve. That structure lets the City respond to changing economic conditions without the expense of repeated elections — while voters keep control of the maximum.

Every dollar stays here in Gilroy. By law, this local funding cannot be taken by Sacramento. Revenue supports the services residents rely on: street and pothole repair, park and recreation programs, emergency preparedness for storms, flooding, and wildfires, and police and fire response.

The measure also includes annual independent audits to provide transparency and accountability.

An 11% rate generates approximately $300,000 annually; the 13% maximum, approximately $700,000 — meaningful funding for a city our size, at no cost to residents.

Please join me in voting YES on Measure B.

Greg Bozzo

Greg Bozzo

Mayor, City of Gilroy